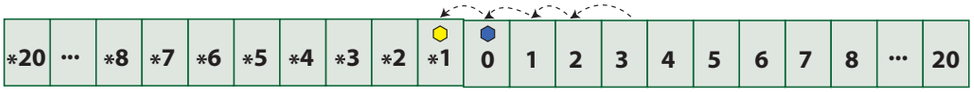
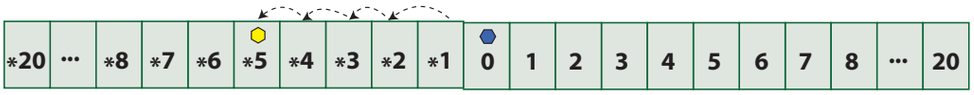
Teacher : To sustain the interest in the game, continue playing with a small addition in the rule as whoever reaches ∗20 first, will also be considered as the winner!

Yuvan : So Subha, you shall keep it at ∗1.



Yuvan : What, if you pick the red card again which shows 4 ?

Subha : I am clear Yuvan. I will move backward 4 places from ∗1 to keep my token at ∗5.



Yuvan : Well said…! What can you say, assuming that I am at 5?

Subha : Yes, Yuvan. We will be at the same distance but on the opposite sides of '0'. Am I right?

Yuvan : Yes. you are right but your value is less than mine as you go to the left of '0'.

Think

Who will win finally? Which is the factor that will decide the winner? How far can you extend the numbers on both sides of the strip?

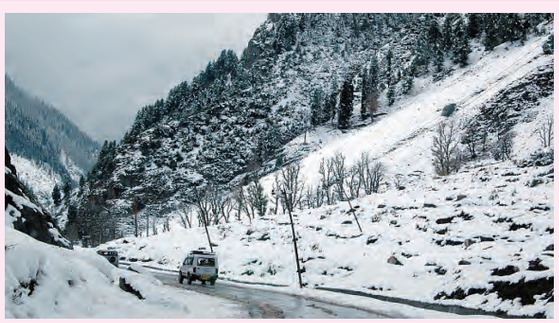
From the above game, we understand that there is a need to go beyond 0 on to its left! We also observe that as 1 is to the right of 0, there should exist ∗1 to its left with the same distance as 1 and it extends on both sides in the same way.

We generalise this ∗ symbol to '–' (minus or negative sign) to denote the numbers less than '0' which conveys the meaning as less, deficit, reduce, down, left, etc.,

MATHEMATICS ALIVE – INTEGERS IN REAL LIFE



Mariana Snailfishes live in the Mariana Trench at 26,200 feet below the sea level.



Temperature in the Ladakh region of India records at –14°C below 0°C on an average in the month of January every year.

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